

INTERNATIONAL

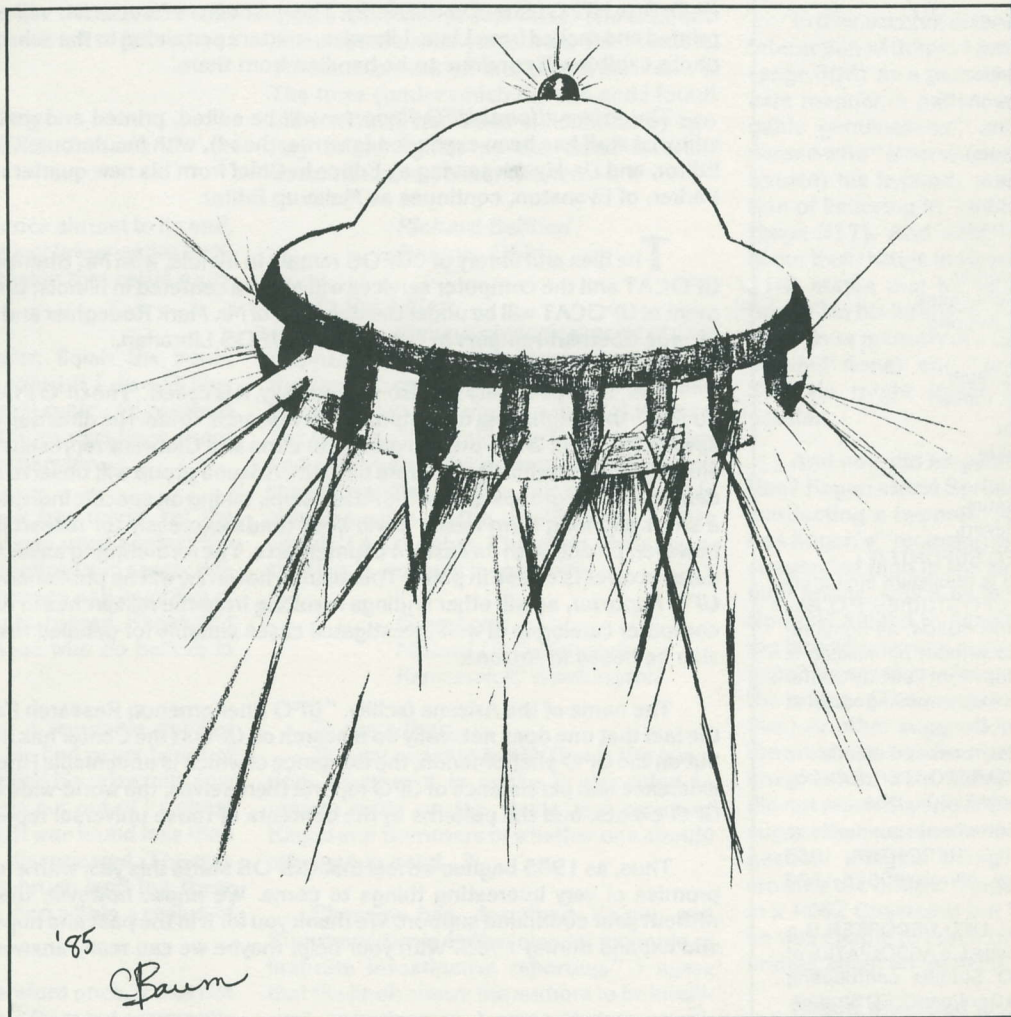
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UFO

REPORTER



A Very Close CE1...



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EDITORIAL — WHY UFOS

This is a question many of us have long pondered, but in this case it is not a question, it's the telephone number of the new UFO Phenomenon Research Facility of CUFOS in Scottsdale, Arizona. Just put 602 in front of the WHY and you have the complete phone number:

602 WHY UFOS

The Arizona facility, or "CUFOS WEST," is located at 6159 E. Indian School Rd., in Scottsdale (a suburb of Phoenix), and is a short distance from the new Hynek residence.

Understandably, our readers may be a bit puzzled about the relationship of the Lima, Ohio, the Evanston (now to be the Glenview), Illinois, and the Scottsdale "branches" of CUFOS, and so here is a brief explanation:

The Business Office of CUFOS remains in Lima, in charge of John Timmerman, the Chairman of the CUFOS Board and Treasurer. Financial matters in general, subscriptions to the *IUR* and the *ANL*, and all questions pertaining to address changes, as well as all general correspondence relating to Center matters, should be directed to the Lima office (P.O. Box 1621, Lima, Ohio 45802). The *Associates Newsletter* will continue to be edited, printed and mailed from Lima. Likewise, matters pertaining to the scheduling of the CUFOS photo exhibit will continue to be handled from there.

The *International UFO Reporter* will be edited, printed and mailed from Illinois. Its editorial staff has been expanded (see masthead), with Mr. Jerome Clark, of Evanston, as Editor, and Dr. Hynek serving as Editor-in-Chief from his new quarters in Arizona. Ms. Ann Parker, of Evanston, continues as Make-up Editor.

The files and library of CUFOS remain in Illinois, with Mr. Sherman Larsen in charge. UFOCAT and the computer services will also be centered in Illinois; updating and management of UFOCAT will be under the direction of Mr. Mark Rodeghier and Mr. Fred Merritt. Mr. George Eberhart remains in Chicago as CUFOS Librarian.

Now, the new facility in Arizona: Formally, it is called "The UFO Phenomenon Research Facility" thus signalling the emphasis on research. Under the direction of Dr. Hynek, it has a special function. While the two groups in Lima and Glenview represent a closely integrated, although geographically separate unit, the Arizona group will observe a degree of independence from the groups east of the Mississippi, taking on specific individual projects, on both a short and long term basis. It will seek funds expressly for research purposes working, however, closely with its eastern counterparts. The forthcoming association with the Hessdalen project is a case in point. The results, however, will be published in the *International UFO Reporter*, as will other findings resulting from the researches in Arizona. UNICAT, the computer catalogue of well-investigated cases suitable for detailed research purposes, will also be based in Arizona.

The name of the Arizona facility, "UFO Phenomenon Research Facility," emphasizes the fact that one does not really do research on UFOs (the Center has none on ice to study!) but on the UFO phenomenon, the existence of which is undeniable [the phenomenon is the existence and persistence of UFO reports themselves, the world-wide body of witnesses to UFO events, and the patterns in the contents of those universal reports].

Thus, as 1985 begins, we feel that CUFOS starts this year with a new vitality and with a promise of very interesting things to come. We know, however, that little can be done without your continued support. We thank you for it in the past and hope that it will continue and expand during 1985. With your help, maybe we can really answer the question:

WHY UFOS?

CATTLE MUTILATIONS: An Exchange

Letters

To the editor:

After reading Mark Chesney's review of *Mute Evidence* (*IUR*, November/December 1984), I can only hope that Chesney and authors Daniel Kagan and Ian Summers never look into other vast UFO abysses such as psychic-oriented contacts, the ape entities or those diabolic enforcers, the men in black. They would easily explain away and bury these important categories in the UFO game of reality distortion. Then what would we stupid UFO buffs have left to jazz up our imaginary world?

Don Worley
Connersville, Indiana

To the editor:

I read *Mute Evidence* almost to its end, fascinated by the excellent investigative techniques and the conclusion that cattle mutilations are a sham.

I did not, however, finish the book. There is something about it I do not like. Perhaps it is the authors' cynicism; maybe it is the way Kagan and Summers heap scorn on those who think otherwise.

Certainly the book has merit. Yet the same technique has been used against the UFO phenomenon, ignoring valid cases, ridiculing intelligent witnesses and laughing at government documents. Indeed, Kagan and Summers ridicule those who do believe in UFOs.

I also thought of a reputable rancher near Salmon, Idaho. He had never heard of mutilations until he found his prize milk cow dead, a perfect triangle cut out of its chest and no blood present. It was found less than 18 hours after it had disappeared. The cow lay in arid, dusty sagebrush land but there were no prints of any kind within a radius of 1,000 feet.

I found a dead Hereford once. It was not mutilated in the classic form but apparently had been butchered. It was not on the Great Plains but in a suburb of Dayton, Ohio. All of the meat had been stripped from the leg bones. Hoofs had been severed as had the head. The leg bone separation points were

above the joints. All were smooth. Nowhere was there a single saw, hatchet or knife mark. There were no teeth imprints. The severed ends were shiny and solid throughout.

Two months had expired (we think) but no dog, crow, skunk or opossum seemed to have touched the remains. The dead yearling was exactly under the position that two responsible young women had indicated was the location of a helicopter type of UFO, minus rotor blades and noise. The craft had been less than 80 yards from their vehicle. Their motor was off and the window down. The trees (under which my son and I found the remains) had been silhouetted by two very bright lights, so the exact location could not have been mistaken.

Richard Seifried
Dayton, Ohio

To the editor:

From a sociopsychological point of view it appears Kagan and Summers have solved the "mute" mystery. But for the UFOs seen in connection with mutes—the sightings by Tex Graves, Gabe Valdez and others—Kagan and Summers offer no explanation; in fact they completely ignore them, presumably because, like cattle mutilations, UFOs couldn't exist either. Therefore, their investigation is woefully incomplete.

Greg Long
Mutual UFO Network
Kennewick, Washington

To the editor:

To beef or not to beef? That is the question. Whether it is nobler in the mind to remain mute on the slants and errors of Kagan and Summers or whether one should take pen in hand...?

Chesney has described Kagan and Summers' book as "an elegant example of first-rate investigative reporting." I agree that the book shows the authors to be intelligent investigators; I agree that the book shows the authors to be skillful writers; I do not agree, however, that the book provides a solution to the mystery of cattle mutilations.

I do not know personally all the actors

and actresses in the scenarios that the authors have presented to readers. But I know and admire several of the "mute" investigators, including Linda Moulton Howe, Thomas Adams, Howard Burgess and David Perkins. I have met Kagan; I have not met Summers; but when I read their writings, I become more aware of their method if not their motive. Their method is tried and true: kill the messenger who brings nasty news or, at least, ridicule and ignore the message.

In their account of their (actually Kagan's) interaction with me, I am described initially (page 308) as a person with a "warm, sincere manner, a patient attitude, and a palpable genuineness" and eventually as a person who "steers" (pun presumably unintended) his hypnotic subjects in the direction of believing in "saucers" and "aliens" (page 317). And what happened to bring about that change in viewpoint? Kagan (page 314) stated that he was "looking for two things" in his interview with Sprinkle: a subconscious memory of a UFO experience (he recalled none) and "any influence" that Sprinkle might inject into the hypnotic session.

And how did he go about his investigation? Kagan asked Sprinkle to assist him by conducting a hypnotic session. One topic was Kagan's "recurring dream" about being suspended high in the air over one end of a high bridge, which he feels he must cross. Sprinkle agreed to assist Kagan by providing him with several suggestions during the hypnosis session—for example, try to cross the bridge. (The suggestion was not effective.) Another suggestion: move forward in time an hour, two hours, etc. (Kagan, in his imagination, went ahead six hours but he did not reach the end of the bridge; again the suggestion was ineffective.) A further suggestion: imagine riding in a vehicle that crosses the bridge. (Kagan imagined a ride in a 1962 Chevrolet; but in his imagination he was unable to reach the other side of the bridge; again an ineffective suggestion.)

Kagan wondered about the possibility that the suggestion of an "aircraft" could be useful in his imaginary quest. Of course, he was thinking of an "airplane." But what did Sprinkle suggest? A "spacecraft"! So Kagan

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The Case Against the IFO

I was most interested to read the *IUR* editorial (Vol. 9, No. 4, July/August 1984) in which the AAAS session "Edges of Science" was reviewed and the opinions of James Oberg discussed. Oberg appears to believe that, because certain Russian space launches have been misinterpreted by the Soviet population (thanks, it must be said, to a rather big helping hand from the Soviet authorities), he can extrapolate from this that all prime UFO cases are suspect as grossly exaggerated IFOs.

Allen Hynek offers a cogent response to this argument. But I would like to add to his remarks a discussion of some research I've done on the matter. I have reported on this in my book *UFO Reality* (Robert Hale, London, 1983), but as my books are virtually impossible for American researchers to find, I think a summary is worth offering:

Four Stages

In my view there are four stages in the acquisition of UFO data. Stage one is the UFO "Event" (the original stimulus). This can be something mundane (such as Venus) or it can be a genuine unknown. Whatever the case, it is always perceived via the senses and so we are left in every witness with a stage two datum, the UFO "Sighting."

I have examined a number of instances in which the primary difficulty occurs between "Event" and "Sighting." A particularly illustrative example happened one very frosty December morning when unusual atmospheric clarity made Venus unusually prominent. In late morning, just a few hours after the Venus "Event," a local couple reported a UFO "Sighting" and I obtained their testimony. They had seen a bright light, through the mediums of both tired eyes and frost on their windowpane, as a somewhat distorted bright light. Once they decided they were watching a UFO, they kept it in view for a long time; the husband even pursued it across some marshland. Eventually, it faded into a point source as the morning sky brightened.

Despite the couple's extreme language in describing the "Sighting," it was still possible to determine what they had seen. Their distortions had not totally altered the inherent behavior of Venus, which had conducted itself as it always does. Had I been informed that the light had landed and disgorged little creatures, the investigative problem confronting me would not have been so simple.

by Jenny Randles

Stage three in our progression is the UFO "Account," which the witness gives us. The major difficulty here is that the more times the account is repeated, the more convoluted the story becomes. It absorbs details from the responses of those to whom it is told and the witness frequently reshapes his observation in his own mind.

In the Venus IFO case just described, I was able to see this process in action when the witnesses talked to a local newspaper and gave a television interview describing their "Account." These media sources wanted a UFO story (I know because I told the newspaper what the true stimulus was; it was not interested). This desire obviously transmitted itself to the witnesses. Within 24 hours of the "Event" the witnesses' "Account" was now quite different. They had elaborated on what they originally told me and now had a firmly-rooted shape for the UFO (a most unusual one) and were even contemplating a landing (which was in reality a lie-of-the-land illusion).

Had a ufologist come on the scene now, he would have faced great difficulty in discovering what the witnesses had seen. They were no longer describing Venus. I did, however, demand (and get) TV air time to refute their version—advising viewers to go out the next morning, if clear, and look in exactly the direction that the witnesses had said they looked. I promised them a sight of the "UFO." It was now only two days later and Venus was in more or less the same sky position.

As it happens, members of a UFO group not noted for its investigative competence appeared on the scene at this point. I de-

cided to keep quiet and monitor what happened.

I was not surprised to discover that less than two days after the "Sighting" they interviewed the witnesses and showed them a set of UFO pictures, asking them to choose the one they felt their UFO looked like. Following this incredible action, the witnesses selected one of George Adamski's photos and the group promptly went on to the fourth and final stage, offering a UFO "Report" to the UFO community. This "Report" incorporated all their prejudices and preconceptions as well as the follies that followed the case's progression from "Event" to "Account."

The group's ultimate UFO "Report" averred that a strange craft had landed beside the couple's house. But, of course, all that had occurred was the observation of Venus.

This IFO case study taught me more than hundreds of genuine UFO events and I began to look much more carefully at IFO events, such as those Allan Hendry documented in his *UFO Handbook*. I have since become concerned by the number of cases in which extreme UFO "Accounts" have been generated by witnesses of "Events" as mundane as an observation of the moon.

But what I wanted to know (in a way preempting Oberg) was whether any typical strange UFO "Account" may just be the result of a primary "Event" which had gone through the range of circumstances I have outlined. (I talk here of "Accounts" rather than "Reports" because I can view "Accounts" personally in terms of cases I investigate before anybody else—thus bypassing the fourth stage of the progression.)

It was at this point that fate and the heavens lent a helping hand.

"This IFO case study taught me more than hundreds of genuine UFO events, and I began to look much more carefully at IFO events..."

Cosmos "Event"

On New Year's Eve, December 31, 1978, a remarkable UFO "Event" occurred. For several minutes a brilliant shape-changing whitish object slowly traversed the skies of Britain at about 19:05 hours. As this was a busy party night, many people were out and about (mostly en route to parties). There were few clouds, making viewing conditions nearly optimum. Probably thousands of people throughout the United Kingdom observed the phenomenon.

It took ufologists a very short time to discover what had happened. The booster from a Russian satellite, Cosmos 1068, which had been launched a few days earlier, had reentered the atmosphere and burned up in a spectacular show. Debris came down over Germany but it was the British Isles that got the best view as the train of burning matter came down. Of course such an explanation was not apparent to most of the witnesses. To them it was just a sky mystery—in other words, a UFO.

Two other factors combined to make this mass sighting of great interest. Some months earlier the movie *Close Encounters of the Third Kind* had been released in Britain and it was still playing. This was the first major UFO spectacular since the movie's release and so the public's minds were very easily attuned to the UFO enigma. What is even more significant is that at exactly this time the famous New Zealand movie-film case had occurred at Kaikoura and the air-born pictures were being flown around the world to create a media sensation (in Britain over the next couple of days they even made leading items on TV news broadcasts). The British public was conditioned as never before into a UFO state-of-mind. Not surprisingly, the extensive newspaper reports on the British reentry observations frequently suggested a link with the events in New Zealand.

I watched all of this with some fascination because I quickly realized that it presented ufology with a unique opportunity. We practically had an experimental situation presented to us. Here was the chance for real scientific work.

Let me add that I did not recognize the significance immediately. Nor did I truly grasp what could be done until I caught sight of the few witness accounts of the Cosmos

The majority of witnesses placed the time at 19:08 hours, known to be the approximate midpoint of the IFO event.

1068 reentry. At that point I realized I had the opportunity to test the premise that "all UFOs are exaggerated IFOs" under experimental conditions. To this end I set about collating as many written "Accounts" from witnesses as I could. I was helped in this regard by one group in particular, the North Lancashire UFO Group, which although it realized that Cosmos 1068 probably was to blame, nevertheless felt it should take no chances and should collect statements anyway. A few others reacted similarly and over the next year or two I managed to acquire a large sample—certainly the largest number of independent accounts of the same primary event that I have personally ever come across.

I should stress that the identification of the phenomenon as Cosmos 1068 was not widely known. By the time this was confirmed, the media had lost interest in the story and the only real explanations proffered were a few hasty official statements to the effect that "stars" or "bright meteors" probably had been viewed. Consequently, most of the accounts I had to study were from genuinely puzzled observers who had seen what they still took to be a UFO.

For the purposes of my research I selected 100 cases out of about 130 possibilities, eliminating those with insufficient data. My 100 accounts were a typical cross-section of observations of the 1978 reentry.

I looked at these accounts from a number of different points of view to assess how accurate certain features were recorded. I will summarize a few examples below.

Witnesses ranged from school children and housewives to scientists, airline pilots and police officers. The bias was, of course, toward the more ordinary member of the public. There was no detectable difference from the usual list of UFO witnesses.

Ninety-seven percent described the time of the event as between 19:00 and 19:20 hours, with the majority centering on 19:08 (known to be the approximate mid-point of the event). One of the least accurate accounts was from a police officer in Hertfordshire. Allegedly taken from the clock in the police station, this time was about 10 minutes in error. Only three accounts gave wildly erroneous times. One spoke of 21:00 (nearly two hours late) and the other two were less than an hour too early. But in one of these cases, there are reasonable grounds to suspect that the event was an entirely different phenomenon confabulated to look like the basic Cosmos 1068 description after the witness had read many media reports.

Eighty-seven percent were more-or-less correct in estimating the direction of the object as northwest-southeast. Only two were way off—but both were in open country and away from any obvious means of getting their bearings.

Duration is something a ufologist would expect to be reported inaccurately. And in this case the phenomenon will have been viewed for varying lengths of time according to differing circumstances (e.g., the amount of sky visible to the witness). But the vast majority recorded time lengths between two and three minutes, which is probably close to reality. Almost nobody said under one minute, but three did talk of 10 minutes' duration (certainly an exaggeration). There were no descriptions which had the object "streaking past in seconds" or "hanging around for half an hour or an hour." If you plotted a distribution curve of durations, the median would be close to accuracy—and the times offered are certainly good enough to rule out things such as meteors.

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Case Against the IFO — continued

We turn now to the description of the *stimulus*. Colors varied from white to yellow to pale orange (and each is a possible option—the true color being a sort of yellowish white). *Shape* was consistent (variously given as cigar/sausage/tadpole/cylinder). There were no domed discs or other such fanciful interpretations. Not a single account was wildly distorted from the true shape (which did vary from round to oval).

The train of burning debris produced an interesting illusionary effect which is well known to psychologists. The isolated “bits” were connected up by several witnesses and interpreted as bright windows along the edge of a dark-bodied craft. Their sketches “filled in” the unseen body and so enhanced the “cigar” or “cylinder.” But the most common description of this effect was that “the object looked like a railway carriage in the sky.”

Fortunately we had a movie film of the object, taken by witness Paul Rimmer at Morecambe, Lancashire. This gives us a scale against which to interpret recorded shapes. Probably because this film (when developed) aided Rimmer’s recall and prevented distortion from confabulation, his verbal description of the shape of the object was among the most accurate.

The single most inaccurate elements were *height* and *apparent size*. These varied wildly from “a pea at arm’s length” through “a quarter the size of the full moon” to “10 times the size of a low-flying jet aircraft.” All of these errors had to do with the almost universal (and quite understandable) assumption that the event was occurring at a height of just a few thousand feet rather than miles (as it actually was). Even air traffic controllers at Manchester Airport estimated the object’s height at about 4,000 feet.

These last remarks ought not to surprise any experienced investigator. But they have convinced me that the traditional questions of height and size of the object should not be asked of a witness. They are grossly

misleading and if interpreted literally could be dangerous. I feel ufologists should concentrate on those aspects about which we can have some degree of confidence. No witness to a UFO event observed at night can possibly estimate with any degree of accuracy the height (and thus size) of the phenomenon being viewed.

What about explanations proffered for the phenomenon? There were several ideas. No fewer than 15 percent of the witnesses said they originally thought it was an aircraft on fire and about to crash. Several fire brigades reported they had been called out to nonexistent air crashes that night. Other popular ideas were a “rocket taking off,” a “distress flare” and several “remarkably bright meteors.” Of course, in the end most of the reporters did settle for the “UFO” identification, which under the circumstances was entirely reasonable. Nobody described what he or she saw as a “spaceship,” although a few accounts began to head in that direction. (Ironically, in this case the object was a “spaceship.”)

Of the 100 accounts there was only one which described any kind of associated effect—a dog’s barking in Birmingham. The dog could have been barking at the reentry; if human beings got excited by it, why shouldn’t animals? Or it may have been a spurious link. But it was never seriously offered as “animal disturbance,” care of the UFO, even by the witness.

There were no accounts of entities, car stops, physical traces, effects on witnesses and so forth. None of the accounts described an object either unrecognizable or grossly out of phase with what the reentry did look like. One account mentioned a brief hovering period and two others slight direction changes. But both are minor optical illusions. Overall, the accounts were remarkably accurate.

Of course, you might regard this as an isolated result. But in the Condon report William K. Hartmann did a similar study on the reentry of Zond IV over the United States. And his results were not very different from mine.

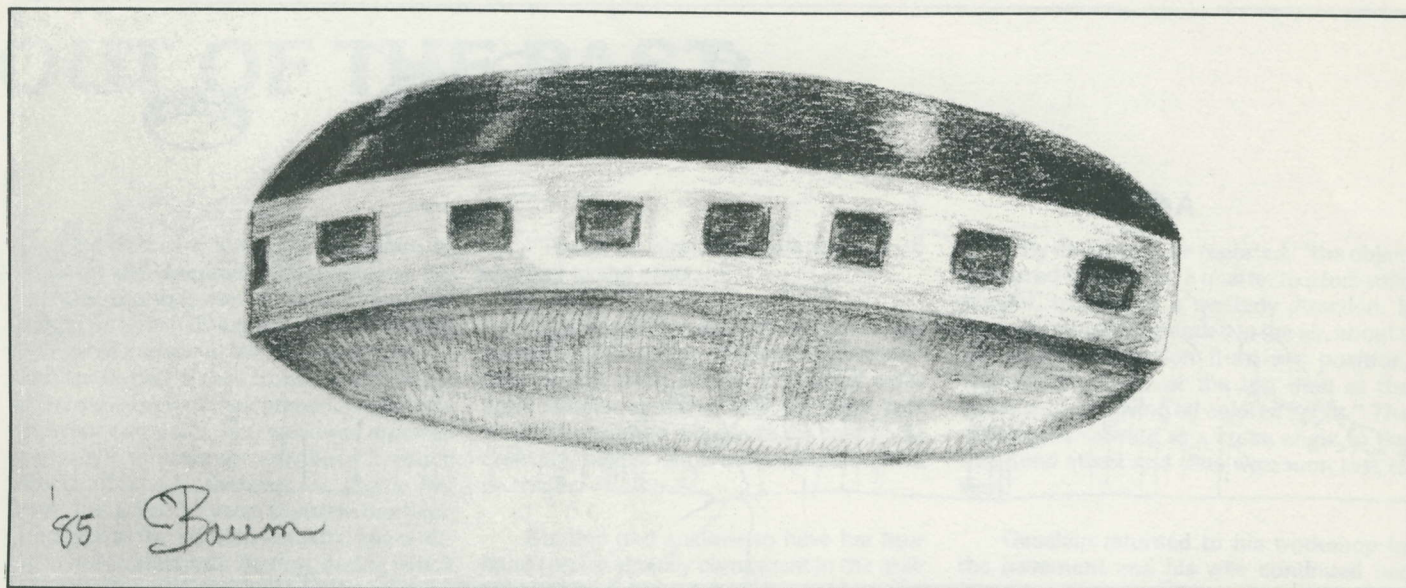
Few Exotic Accounts

The difference in the 1978 British “experiment” was that here we had prime opportunities for gross exaggerations to occur. There was a climate of UFO interest thanks to Steven Spielberg’s movie. There was the coincidence of the New Zealand film sensation. It was New Year’s Eve (when, with the consumption of alcohol way above normal, witness perceptions were more prone to distortions). And there was this most unusual stimulus of which British citizens were generally ignorant and for which they were quite unprepared.

In my view, if Oberg’s theories are in any way credible, then here we should have had many instances of “exotic” UFO accounts. Perhaps a critic will charge that I have missed those that did occur. But, if the proportion is less than one in 100, then we have difficulty accounting for the fact that 10 in 100 of the reports that come to our attention are UFOs, not IFOs. It seems to me that the total absence of any of the classic UFO-case types in my Cosmos 1068 study (no CE2, 3 or 4 cases) appears to cast doubt on the premise that “all UFOs are exaggerated IFOs.”

A word of caution. In 1982 I did talk with a witness who described to me his observations of the Cosmos 1068 reentry. He was positive it had occurred on January 31, 1979, and could not be persuaded otherwise. His account was pretty accurate, however, and it was easy to trace back from his description to the reentry. But there were signs of confabulation from constant retelling. And he insisted adamantly that the “streamers” coming out of the back of it confirmed his belief that it was a nuclear-powered spaceship! Even so, he had not wildly distorted the event.

This points up the urgency of investigating cases quickly. Even the passage of hours can seriously reduce the evidential value and the problems increase with further time passage. But when we can get to a witness reasonably soon, we are more likely to learn what really happened. ■



This UFO, spotted by a high school art teacher and his daughter near McHenry, Illinois, had a black top, blue sides, and a red-gold metallic bottom.

"I Know What I Saw..."

Much the same words have been used by many bewildered witnesses to UFO events. Readers who themselves have never gone out to interview such witnesses can hardly appreciate the poignancy of such a remark. This particular case was witnessed by a high school art teacher and his nine-year-old daughter, Kristin, who one late-spring afternoon were watching for birds in a game refuge area. The father told us, "I think it's something my daughter and I will share for the rest of our lives. It's a moment that no one can ever take away from us."

Of course "I know what I saw...but I don't know what I saw" could apply equally to a misidentification by the witness of something quite natural but seen under unusual circumstances. It is here that the skill and knowledge of the interviewer enters: he brings to the interview his ability to listen carefully to voice intonations and to identify body language and to note the way the witness comports himself as the event is once again re-lived. These are things totally un-

available to someone reading a printed account of the event. In more cases than not, there have been several witnesses to the event; the skilled investigator independently interviews each one, preferably at the actual site of the event, whenever time and funds permit. Remember, at present, to the best of our knowledge, there are no paid professional UFO investigators.

TYPE:	DD(CE-1)
DATE:	May 23, 1983
TIME:	7:30 P.M. CDT
DURATION:	1-3 minutes
WITNESSES:	2
PLACE:	Countryside near McHenry, Illinois

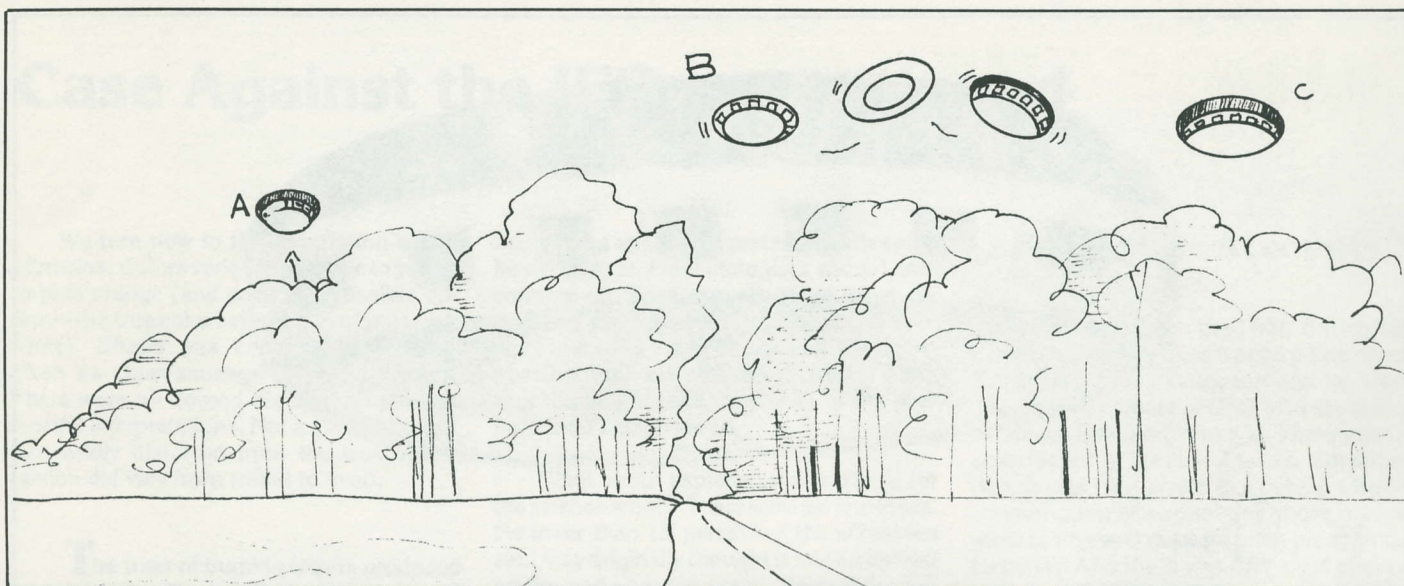
The accompanying drawings of the object and its trajectory were taken directly from sketches submitted by the artist-witness (who wrote to the Center almost immediately after the event and included the drawings). Original artwork was in color so it is not re-

produced here. The interviews did not take place for good reasons until more than a year later. It was apparent that the event was still indelibly etched in the minds of the two witnesses...there was no essential difference between the written description and the verbal statements over a year later.

While parked in their car in an isolated pond area frequented by wild birds, in the early evening while the sky was still quite bright, the father called his daughter's attention to a strange object which he had seen rise from behind the trees (see A). It rocked violently then quickly leveled off, traveling about 25 yards above the tree line (B), and was about 250 yards from the car. Obvious solutions like a balloon or an advertising plane or other small plane were quickly ruled out. The object was going somewhat cross-wind ("I'm always aware of the wind direction, I hunt, and I always set my decoys with the wind.") and was completely silent. It was

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...But I Don't Know What I Saw"



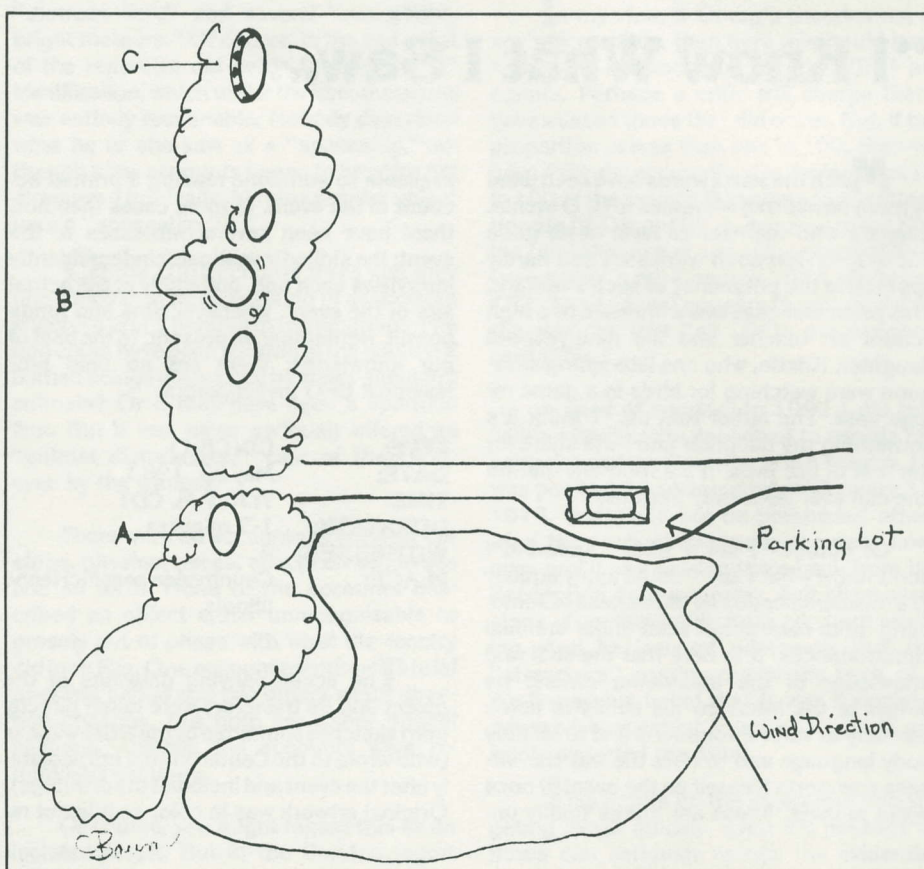
In the above diagram, the witnesses viewed the UFO from the parking lot as it rose from behind the trees (A), rocked violently, then leveled off 25 yards above the tree line (B). It was travelling cross-wind well below the stall speed of an aircraft, and it was completely silent (C).

traveling definitely below the stall speed of an aircraft. The object itself (C) was very sharply outlined and its color, particularly the bottom part, was unusual. "My father paints, you know," said Kristin, "and he'd never seen a color like that." A red-gold metallic color comes closest. [Ed. note: it is possible that the bottom reflected the light of the setting sun.]

Shortly after Kristin's attention was called to it by her father, they both related that the object suddenly seemed to lose control. In separate interviews they said they thought it was going to crash into the trees below. It rocked violently, giving the observers a chance to see portions of the top and bottom, and then as suddenly, it levelled off and proceeded at a faster clip into the distance, following the contour of the land. Kristin added, "It was real close. It was oval and didn't have a propeller. If it'd had a motor, we could've heard it."

Asked what they thought about the incident now, more than a year later, the father said, "We talk about it quite often, but we don't dwell on it. I teach at the high school and I told some of the people what I had seen, but mostly I got razzed."

It's too bad the witnesses didn't have a color camera with them. We do have, however, the drawing by an art teacher (who, we can surmise, is probably a good observer of details), done immediately after the event.



This aerial diagram shows the same motions as the diagram above. From their car in the parking lot, the witnesses were approximately 250 yards from where the UFO rose, rocked, and travelled over the tops of the trees.

OUT OF THE PAST:

As part of a long-range program to follow up well-documented cases from the past (for the purpose of determining life-effects, present thoughts about the past UFO-event and about the UFO phenomenon itself on the part of the witness or witnesses, and to see how well their present memory of the event compares with what was reported originally), we have recently been in touch with Lt. Col. J.A. Gasslein Jr. (Army Reserve, Ret.). For 30 years Gasslein has been employed in the aviation industry, specializing in helicopters with Boeing, during which time he has been "exposed to all types of aircraft." In 1962 he reported two cases occurring within minutes of each other (presumably sightings of the same object) and witnessed by several independent observers. Dr. James McDonald, who was interested in the case, corresponded with Gasslein and with NICAP investigators. Gasslein has been kind enough to respond to our queries. Below is a recap of the original reports and Gasslein's present comments about the many-year-old sightings.

Sighting 1

TYPE: CE-1
DATE: April 24, 1962
TIME: Approx. 7:45 P.M.
DURATION: 5+/- minutes
WITNESSES: 3 + several indept't.
PLACE: Springfield, Pennsylvania

Sighting 2

TYPE: CE-1
DATE: April 24, 1962
TIME: Approx. 8:10 P.M.
DURATION: 3-5 minutes
WITNESSES: 3 + several indept't.
PLACE: Springfield, Pennsylvania

Sighting 1

It was a clear spring night. The sun had set an hour before, and Mrs. Gasslein and her mother had just driven out of their driveway and were less than two blocks from their suburban home when "coming in level with the roofs of the Cape Cod homes was this very large round thing, surmounted with a dome that was emitting flashes of green light."

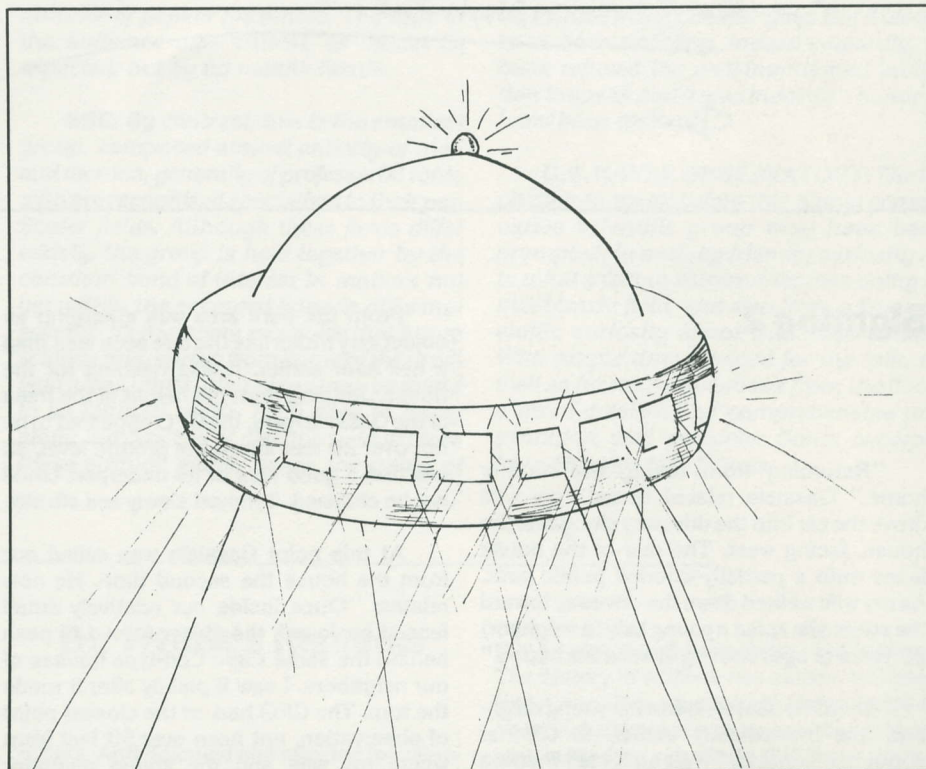
"That's no airplane!" one woman exclaimed to the other.

A band, rotating around the main body, consisted of a series of square "windows" from which came shafts of brilliant white light. Similar shafts of brilliant white light were directed downward from the base of the craft; the object had a well-defined outline, or shape.

Startled and anxious to have her husband (professionally competent in the matter of aircraft) witness the bizarre object, she quickly returned to her house and rushed in to get him. He responded immediately and ran up the street to get a better view.

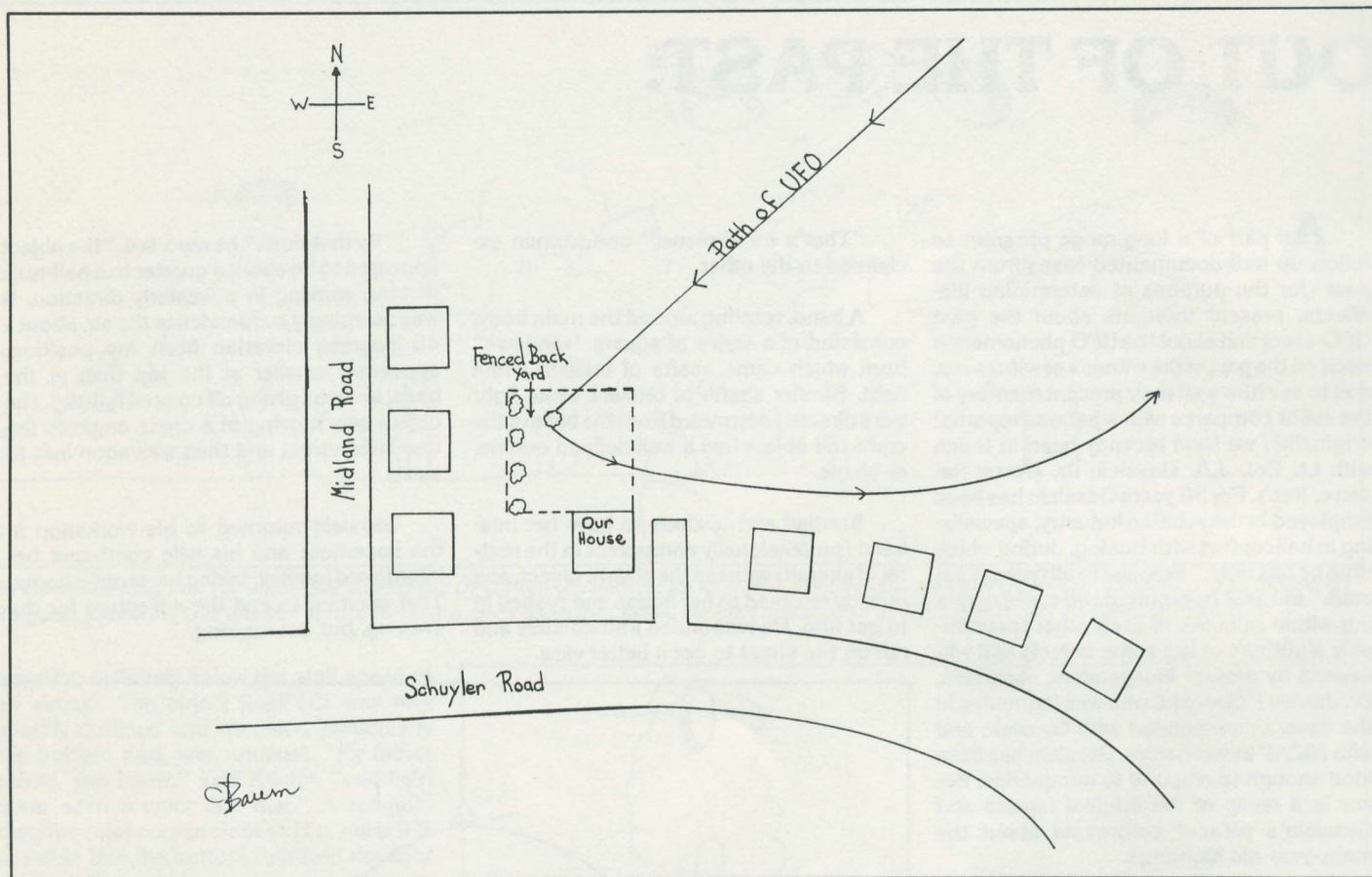
"By that time," he reported, "the object appeared to be about a quarter to a half-mile distant, moving in a westerly direction. It was seemingly suspended in the air, about a 45 degrees elevation from my position, appearing smaller at the top than at the base, and was giving off colored lights." The object was moving at a cross angle to the tree-lined street and thus was soon lost to view.

Gasslein returned to his workshop in the basement and his wife continued her interrupted journey, taking her mother home. That seemed to end the adventure for the evening, but not for long.



The UFO, which appeared to be no more than 20 feet above the witness' small fenced-in yard, had a slowly rotating band of square, equally-spaced 'windows' from which a brilliant white light emanated. Light was also diffused downward from the bottom of the UFO.

A Very Close CE-1



Sighting 2

"Returning from taking her mother home," Gasslein related to us, "my wife drove the car into the driveway alongside the house, facing west. The rear of the house faces onto a partially-wooded public park. As my wife walked down the driveway toward the street she spied a young lady (a neighbor) 20 years of age, coming toward the house."

When Mrs. Gasslein saw her young neighbor, she immediately wanted to tell her about her sighting. "Wait until I tell Barbara what I saw!" she thought, as she related later on.

But she never got the chance. Mrs. Gasslein recalls, "She was looking up with her mouth wide open and said, 'My God, what's that?'"

From the park area was emerging an object very much like the one seen less than a half-hour earlier. It was heading for the house. Judging from the height of the trees in the Gasslein yard, the UFO appeared to be not over 20 feet above the ground level, so low that a good view of its underpart could not be obtained. It moved slowly and silently.

At this point Gasslein was called out from the house the second time. He now relates: "Once inside our relatively small fenced backyard, the object turned to pass behind the same Cape Cod-type houses of our neighbors. I saw it plainly after it made the turn. The UFO had, at the closest point of observation, not been over 50 feet from where my wife and the young neighbor were standing.

"The object presented a dramatic sight. Strangely, the brilliant white light emanating from the rotating band of square 'windows', and from the base, caused no eye discomfort whatsoever. Again the object had a

clear-cut outline/structure, and was itself dark in appearance.

"After passing along the backs of the adjacent properties, the UFO disappeared from our view, passing over higher ground. It left no signs, either on the ground or in the foliage of the trees, of its having been in the area."

Immediately after this second sighting, both Mrs. Gasslein and her neighbor went into the house and independently drew pencil sketches of the UFO. The sketches agreed in basic details, and tallied with Gasslein's own observation.

The actual size was not difficult to estimate since, as Mrs. Gasslein related, "It came toward us, about as far as 10 feet from the house, moving slowly and making no noise." The witnesses estimated the diameter of the object to be 30 feet.

Continued on page 14

Stars and Ivory Towers

In recent months Dr. Hynek was invited to speak about UFOs before four rather widely differing audiences, differing not only in their knowledge of and attitude toward the UFO subject but in the breadth as well as the depth of their scientific training and outlook.

Although his presentation was essentially the same in all four cases, it differed in extent and in details, tailored, we hope appropriately, for each audience. The earliest was in May 1984 before the American Association for the Advancement of Science (AAAS) at its annual meeting in New York. In October it was before the Society for Scientific Exploration (SSE), held on the Princeton University campus; then in November, to the Committee for the Scientific Investigation of Claims of the Paranormal (CSICOP), held on the campus of Stanford University; and the last to the astronomers and naval officers at the U.S. Naval Observatory in Washington, D.C., in December.

The gist of the first presentation, in May, was published in Vol. 9, No. 4, of the *International UFO Reporter* (July/August issue) and since this did not differ materially from that of the later three, it will not be duplicated here. But we will comment upon and contrast the four meetings and, in particular, note the manner in which essentially the same presentation content was received by the four audiences. The talk at the Naval Observatory will be treated more fully, mainly because it was

given the most time and, therefore, allowed ideas to be developed more substantially.

It is of interest to contrast the four scientific groups as represented by the four audiences:

AAAS: This is by far the largest of the four, representing the total scientific spectrum, all the sciences from A to Z. It would be impossible to absorb all that goes on during the AAAS' annual meeting since a great many scientific sessions are in progress simultaneously. Only a small number of the total attendees, therefore, heard the UFO presentation, which itself was a part of the morning-long session on "The Edges of Science." Virtually no time was allowed for discussion because of the number of papers presented. The tone of the audience was critical, as would be expected, but by no means hostile.

SSE: By contrast, this is the smallest group, composed almost entirely of men and women, generally of professorial rank, who are recognized specialists in their particular fields. Although these fields differ widely, the group is held together by the common bond of interest in matters not yet within the accepted bounds of formal science. Its members recognize that future science may spring from some of these off-beat areas while other areas may be found to be without merit. They seek to hurry along the process of discovery, to explore these strange areas; hence the name of

the group, Society for Scientific Exploration. Speaking to these people was a delight because of their willingness to listen, weigh and consider, and not to dismiss out of hand.

CSICOP: On paper, the aims of this group would appear to be identical with those of SSE; yet CSICOP's emphasis is different. The group is composed of many prestigious names—some scientists, journalists, philosophers, magicians and science-fiction writers. They are held together by a common desire to stamp out pseudoscience in our society. While no one could argue with such a laudable aim, nonetheless critics have charged that the attitude of the group as a whole is that any topic or subject which is not already fully accepted by the scientific world is a priori pseudoscience. Time will tell whether this criticism is truly justified.

Considering that Philip J. Klass is CSICOP's chief UFO spokesman, Hynek knew that a speech before the group would be, to put it mildly, challenging. But it would have been unfitting, indeed cowardly, to have refused the well-intentioned invitation to speak and it was indeed an honor to have been invited.

U.S. NAVAL OBSERVATORY: The invitation to speak before this highly conservative scientific group may have been prompted, in part, by friendly curiosity as to what a fellow astronomer was doing in this bizarre field, and also from a true scientific curiosity about the subject itself. With ample time allowed for the talk, as well as for many questions from the floor, a more detailed and comprehensive presentation was possible. Some excerpts from Hynek's talk follow:

Dr. Hynek's Remarks

It is difficult to describe cogently and intelligently, in an hour or so, a phenomenon which by its very nature is bizarre, incredibly unaccountable for by common sense, and yet which has for the past several decades (at least) been reported from around the world, and often by persons of considerable technical and scientific background.

It is a phenomenon which, because of its incredible nature, has elicited the ridicule of the scientific community as well as of

others. And ridiculed and rejected for seemingly sound scientific reason—that reason being, in short, that astronomical distances are so unimaginably great that by no technology known to us could "they get here from there." This, of course, puts the cart before the horse; it assumes that of necessity UFOs can represent one and only one

thing—spacecraft from distant civilizations. The history of science has shown, however, that it was often a mistake to characterize an observed phenomenon by one theory alone and, indeed, to substitute that theory for the phenomenon itself.

Yet despite the disparagement of the scientific community, UFO reports exist and continue to persist, and from all over the

Continued on page 12

Stars & Towers — cont.

world. General Samford once described UFO reports as "incredible tales told by credible people." There is, indeed, no dearth of UFO reports from highly competent and responsible persons: military and commercial pilots, meteorologists, engineers, high-tech personnel, and many holding responsible positions in society.

Yet the typical UFO report is basically unbelievable (and here by typical I mean a report whose cause *remains* unexplained even after study by technically competent persons), so unbelievable that it is difficult to take the contents of the report seriously. This has led to the rejection out-of-hand of the UFO phenomenon, particularly by the scientific community.

We have a "Catch 22" situation here: before the UFO phenomenon can be regarded seriously, it must be seriously studied. Yet who will take the time to study it seriously as long as one's peers regard it as unworthy of serious attention? And then, of course, there is the matter of the "funding slot." To whom does the subject "belong"? Which division of the National Science Foundation does one apply to for funding: Astronomy? Psychology? Sociology? Physics? When the time comes that the UFO phenomenon is recognized as a subject of real possible concern to the public and to science, then there will be a scramble in all of these divisions for research funds. We are still in the era of ridicule and serious doubt.

When the German physicist Arnold Sommerfeld, one of the pioneers in atomic physics, wrote Einstein, raising many queries and serious doubts about the Theory of General Relativity, Einstein is supposed to have replied by postcard, on which he scribbled, "YOU WILL BE CONVINCED OF THE THEORY OF GENERAL RELATIVITY AFTER YOU HAVE STUDIED IT. THEREFORE I WILL NOT UTTER A WORD IN ITS DEFENSE."

I have often been tempted to reply in like manner to those who have not studied the UFO phenomenon but who are loud in their denunciations despite the very extensive literature which now exists...in a great many languages...on this subject.

But I *have* studied it, and I *can* utter a few words in its defense. But, perhaps, I had best first utter a few words about how I, as an astronomer, came to be required to study it. [Hynek then related briefly the history of his involvement with the Air Force, and then continues]...

Now had I not been forced, so to speak, to study this subject, I would very probably, even to this day, have remained a cocksure skeptic. You know the adage, I'm sure, "One is apt to be down on what one is not up on." I had certainly been given the opportunity to become up on the subject of UFOs. UFOs, by the way, is a rather unfortunate term, although less ridicule-inviting than the term flying saucer. It suffers from serious semantic problems. It is almost impossible to define adequately, and so I have largely ceased to use it. I favor the term UFO Phenomenon because that is something we can define operationally in terms of itself, and thus without any trace of implied origin.

The UFO Phenomenon can be defined operationally in this three-part manner:

- 1) The existence and persistence of reports from all over the world of what are popularly termed UFOs.
- 2) The existence of a significant body of originators of such reports who possess professional and technical training, often of a high order, and of an even larger body of originators whose testimony would be seriously considered in a court of law as coming from persons judged sane and responsible by commonly accepted standards.
- 3) The existence of definable patterns, or commonalities, within the body of those reports, which do not lend themselves to rational, prosaic explanation; i.e., those reports whose contents contain descriptions of patterns of behavior and appearance which do not conform easily to present technology or, in some cases, which cannot be interpreted through the present scientific paradigm.

So defined, the UFO Phenomenon is a matter of fact and not belief, for it is undeniable that UFO reports exist, that they come from all over the world, that many have been

made by highly responsible persons, and that the reports themselves exhibit repeatable patterns. This is a matter of record for all to read who will.

In the matter of patterns, for example, it is interesting to note the *absence* as well as the *presence* of commonalities. For example, reports of UFOs with wheels are almost nonexistent, nor do we have descriptions of fiery dragons or pink elephants.

It would appear then, from the above, that perhaps we really do not need to utter even one word in defense of the UFO Phenomenon. It is simply there for us to examine.

In describing the UFO Phenomenon the most universal practice has been to present to an audience, or to the readers of a book on the subject, a series of individual cases. This is at best an awkward and time-consuming process. To present even one well-studied UFO case properly to an audience requires a major fraction of an hour, and many pages in a book. Indeed, several hours might be spent in a detailed delineation of even two or three cases. The audience or readers cannot possibly gain an overall view of the UFO Phenomenon in that manner; at best they get a distorted view of the subject, depending on the particular cases chosen for presentation.

Application of the techniques of information analysis can, however, give one a significant overview of the essence of the UFO Phenomenon, a picture of what it's really all about, in less than an hour. As applied here, we can characterize the UFO Phenomenon by what is most frequently reported about it...from all over the world.

We can extract from many hundreds of well-articulated reports what is most frequently reported about the physical nature of the UFO, about its luminous properties, about its dynamic behavior, and about the reported interaction of the UFO with the ambient environment and with the UFO witnesses themselves.

What followed has appeared in summary in the July-August 1984 issue and will appear later in a monograph by Dr. Willy Smith and Dr. Hynek. ■

LETTERS

To the editor:

I read with considerable interest the account of the "Huge Open Triangle" in the September/October issue of *IUR*. For a number of reasons I suspect that the story related by Charles Little is spurious. I will number the issues for convenience in replying:

(1) The verbatim commentary between Little and Jacksonville Center is surprising because the Federal Aviation Administration does not normally release such a transcript, except following an aircraft accident. Considering the extreme anxiety Little reports, it would be surprising if his later recollections would permit a verbatim account.

(2) Little reports that he was "flying at 8,000 feet" and the "night was very clear." Because he was flying below 12,500 feet, in clear weather, he would not be flying in "controlled airspace" and would not need to request clearance to descend—especially to avoid what seemed (allegedly) to be a potential collision threat. Surely an experienced pilot-instructor would know these basic "rules of the road." And if Little did not know them, surely the Jax controller would and would not have said, "Maintain 7,000."

(3) From Little's account of the gross errors in both of his VOR nav-receivers, one might conclude that the proximity of the UFO was causing interference. Yet Little reports no interference in his air-ground radio communications which operate in the same VHF band, adjacent to the VOR channels, just about 100 MHz.

(4) At the time of the alleged incident (October 1967) the U.S. government-funded study at the University of Colorado was underway and had been widely publicized in the news media. If the government was funding a study of UFOs and if the Colorado group was soliciting UFO reports, there surely was no stigma attached to Little if he reported his encounter to the Colorado group. Yet he did not do so.

(5) If Little was reluctant to report the incident to Colorado, FAA controllers were under instructions that they should report

any UFO incidents directly to the Colorado group. (See page 855 of the Condon Report for a copy of the FAA instruction, dated April 4, 1967, instructing controllers to report all UFO incidents to Colorado and even providing two telephone numbers for doing so.)

Yet despite this FAA instruction, if we are to believe Little's account, both the Jacksonville Center and the Washington Center disregarded this instruction, for no such report was submitted to the Colorado project, so far as the record shows.

(6) At the time of the alleged incident, there was an operation called Volunteer Flight Officers Network (VFON) underway. It had been organized several years earlier by Herb Roth, then employed by the United Air Lines training center in Denver. The principal objective was to assist NORAD in the early days of the Space Age in improving its ability to predict when and where a satellite would reenter the atmosphere. The idea was that if, for example, NORAD expected a satellite to reenter, say, over the Pacific early tomorrow morning, it would alert Roth who would determine which airline flights would be flying over the Pacific at that time, and Roth would then alert their crews to be alert and to report back to him; he in turn would inform NORAD. But since the satellite might reenter earlier or later, in an "unexpected" location, all airline crews both domestic and foreign were encouraged to report anything unusual they might see while in flight.

Roth, who was interested in UFOs, at one time headed NICAP's Colorado Section. As he once remarked to me privately, he hoped he might get some interesting UFO reports as well—and he did obtain a very few, along with many meteor/fireball reports. Roth assured all participating airlines that the name of the airline and its flight crew would never be made public without the approval of the airline and the flight crew—to remove all possible stigma for reporting anything unusual. Roth agreed to supply me with copies of the reports on the condition that I abide by his ground rules—which I did.

Now Little claims that he was told that a United Air Lines 727 captain reported see-

ing a giant, triangular-shaped UFO in the Washington, D.C., area and reported it to the Washington Center (actually located in Leesburg, Virginia). Inasmuch as UAL top management approved and authorized Roth's VFON activities, surely there should be no stigma attached to a UAL flight crew's reporting such a sighting to Roth. But I have searched all of the VFON reports for 1967 and 1968 and can find no such report.

I welcome your response and comments.

*Philip J. Klass
Washington, D.C.*

Charles Little Responds

(1) Commentary between me and Jacksonville Center was from my memory, not from a transcript.

(2) We were on an IFR flight plan under radar contact with Jacksonville Center and were told to maintain 8,000 feet. Certainly I know the rules.

(3) I did not say that the UFO was causing interference to our VORs. I just stated what happened.

(4) That's easy for you to say. It wasn't for us.

(5) A) Ditto. B) Obviously the controllers felt the same.

(6) Obviously the airline crew felt the same.

(7) Again, we were not interested in making a report. The other three persons will speak for themselves when you find them.

(8) I welcome all questions, from Mr. Klass or anyone else, in this matter.

To the editor:

Readers of *IUR* may be interested to know about a recent televised debate on UFOs in France. On October 13, Channel

Continued on page 14

PROJECT HESSDALEN

Out of the Past

—continued

From January 14 to February 2, 1985, a concerted effort to probe the nature of the Hessdalen Lights (November/December 1983 and March/April 1984 issues of *IUR*) is scheduled in the small Norwegian town of Hessdalen, about 300 miles north of Oslo. CUFOs has been invited to attend in the person of Dr. Hynek, who has acted as one of the scientific consultants to Project Hessdalen. The project is under the sponsorship of UFO-NORGE, a Norwegian UFO investigative organization which has offices in Bergen, Leirsund and Duken. Several Norwegian and Swedish scientists, as well as Norwegian military personnel, have expressed willingness to help in the endeavor.

A letter to Dr. Hynek reads, in part, "This is an official invitation to attend 'Project Hessdalen, part 2.'....We will house you in our homes and, in Hessdalen, in a cabin. We will also support you with proper clothing...but long underwear and a solid sweater is O.K. to bring along with a pair of warm trousers and warm headwear." Winter in central Norway is rather different from that in Arizona

"We will arrange a meeting at NORE (Norwegian Defence Research Establishment) before or after you visit Hessdalen. Dr. Thrane, astrophysicist, NORE, and Dr. Sigmond, plasma physicist at the University of Trondheim, will attend the Project during the first week. We hope that we get some very good sightings during your visit."

Dr. Hynek's decision to attend, despite the Norwegian cold, was based on results obtained during the first Project Hessdalen, over a year ago. Readers will remember photographs of the Hessdalen lights that appeared in *IUR* (November/December 1983). There is a strong possibility that these sporadic but very definite and distinct lights, which cannot be confused with auroral lights, represent a natural phenomenon. But if so this in itself would be important; they might even represent something as yet unknown to science. Photography under rigorous conditions should yield valuable information as to their nature and possible origin. Results of this work will, of course, be presented in these pages when they become officially available. ■

NICAP files contain correspondence between Gasslein, McDonald and Ted Bloecher. The investigators were interested in locating the names and addresses of several other witnesses who came forward after a brief account of the double sighting became known (particularly from a short item in the *Philadelphia Inquirer* entitled "Strange Objects Seen Over Philadelphia," April 26, 1962). Some dozen additional witnesses were found. The times, locations and descriptions furnished by these witnesses tallied quite well with the sightings of the close encounter witnesses.

Unfortunately, as so frequently happens, no cameras were available. From well-attested experiences, however, it is known that even when witnesses have a camera within reach, when confronted with an utterly foreign, frightening and upsetting encounter, they forget to use it. Sketches generally are available. In this case the composite sketch of the two women witnesses and a map are shown. ■

LETTERS

One of the French national TV networks organized a live 90-minute discussion of the subject. The show was part of a controversial series entitled *Droit de Response* (The Right to an Answer).

Around the moderator were gathered prominent witnesses, scientists and officials from the French government research project GEPAN, which has been the center of much criticism in recent months.

People who viewed the show have reported that its greatest interest was in diversity of opinions and approaches it represented.

Along with television personality Jean-Claude Bourret and GEPAN director Velasco,

there were six witnesses: an Air France pilot, an Alitalia pilot and the people involved in two recently published official field investigations, including Report No. 16. [A translation of this report, involving a January 1981 landing-trace case, appears in the March 1984 issue of *MUFON UFO Journal*.]

Also present, but hidden behind a translucent screen, was Dr. X who told his story (or part of his story) in public for the first time.

A vocal critic of GEPAN, physicist Jean-Pierre Petit, threw numerous barbs at the official approach. His strident attacks were competently fielded by Velasco and by the Inspector General of CNES, Colonel Gruan (who is the former director of the French rocket base in Guyana). I gained the impression from this exchange, however, that the valiant effort undertaken by GEPAN 10 years ago is indeed running out of steam.

The professional scientists included Professor Bounias, who has conducted a thorough analysis of vegetal fibers affected by a UFO. The other French scientist, a Nice astronomer who represented the "rationalist" viewpoint, argued unconvincingly that all UFO phenomena are attributable to natural causes.

I could not help deploring the fact that neither Claude Poher nor Pierre Guerin could join us at the debate. The French had extended a formal invitation to the Soviet Union and to the People's Republic of China to send representatives or to participate by live satellite link. Both had declined and the U.S. Air Force refused to make any statement on the phenomenon. GEPAN's role in international UFO research remains a decidedly lonely one.

Jacques Vallee
Paris ■

Mutilations — continued

reflected on the obvious meaning of Sprinkle's suggestion about "spacecraft" (alias "flying saucer"); Kagan concluded (page 317): "It meant that none of Sprinkle's case histories could be taken seriously...."

Several questions come to mind. If hypnosis is viewed as "persuasion" or as "influence," then who was influencing whom? If Sprinkle was not influential in providing several hypnotic suggestions to Kagan, then was he influential when he provided the "spacecraft" suggestion? Has Kagan interviewed any of approximately 150 persons who have participated in hypnotic sessions with Sprinkle about their UFO abduction experiences? Do these persons or their friends and families believe that Sprinkle has inserted inappropriate suggestions into their apparent memories of their UFO experience? Do independent viewers of video tapes of some sessions believe that inappropriate suggestions have been used?

Is Sprinkle biased? Oh, yes! I claim not only to have had UFO experiences but also to have interviewed several persons who, during hypnotic sessions, have described their fearful reactions and intellectual doubts about their observations of animals being "lifted" into strange aerial craft. I accept the hypothesis that UFO activity is involved in cattle mutilations; yes, I am biased. But I am also trained as a counseling psychologist. I

have been a licensed psychologist since 1966; I have worked with clients for over 30 years, including 20 years of clinical practice in hypnotic procedures. I am sincere in my efforts to be ethical, scientific and competent in my work with people who explore their emotional and intellectual problems, including those persons who are upset and frightened when they experience UFO encounters. My bias is to continue these investigations of UFO experiences.

Kagan and Summers are intelligent and skillful; they have "culled" the evidence on mutilations and they have "culted" their conclusions. But the main question is not whether they are correct or incorrect in their conclusion that obscure (and unknown) cult members are the culprits. The main question is whether their book will encourage us UFO investigators and UFO observers to become more courageous and to speak more openly about our UFO and cattle mutilation observations. Or will their book serve as one more suppressive event to render mute our experience and to make moot our integrity?

I hope that the authors will maintain their high intelligence and their writing skills. And if and when they attain the courage of a Tom Adams, a Howard Burgess, a Linda Howe or a Dave Perkins, I hope that the authors will use their considerable talents to

assist us all in our investigations of the multifaceted mysteries of the UFO experience. Then, perhaps, time will tell the final tale.

R. Leo Sprinkle
Laramie, Wyoming

Mark Chesney Responds:

I am surprised at the volume and vehemence of the letters *IUR* received in response to my review of *Mute Evidence*. I gather that some UFO enthusiasts consider cattle mutilations an unshakable article of faith. Unfortunately for them, the book does indeed demonstrate (1) that all the "mutilations" have prosaic explanations and (2) that they have nothing to do with UFOs. I really fail to see how anyone could read the book carefully (and completely) yet still think that the mutilations are mysterious.

I am particularly pleased that Dr. Sprinkle took time to respond to the review and to Kagan and Summers' criticisms. I wish, however, that instead of simply reaffirming his faith in a UFO-mutilation link and defending the sacred cow of hypnosis, he had addressed the mass of evidence *Mute Evidence* provides for unremarkably prosaic explanations to the "mutilation" nonmystery.

What seems to me most damning of all is that so far the "mutologists" have refused—or been unable—to refute in open debate the points their critics have raised.

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The Hudson Valley Sightings:

A Reply to Dick Ruhl and APRO

In a recent issue of the *APRO Bulletin* (Vol. 32, No. 6) Dick Ruhl and his associates claim they have solved the so-called Hudson Valley Boomerang sightings, which they believe to have been caused by small planes flying in formation.

Over the course of more than two years, after interviews with dozens of technically-qualified witnesses to the sightings (and many more dozens of ordinary but solid citizens), my colleagues and I have come to quite the opposite conclusion, even though we have been aware from the beginning (as I have pointed out in recent *IUR* articles) that, on occasion, some witnesses have mistaken small planes flying in loose formation for UFOs.

We have on record 15 good witnesses who not only saw the planes flying in formation but, on another evening, saw the UFO. All maintained that the planes were easily identified as such but that the UFO was something they had never before seen. Other witnesses saw only the UFO but are emphatic that they were not seeing small planes flying in formation. One of these is Airport Meteorologist Bill Hele who on March 24, 1983, reportedly stood directly under the UFO and, despite his many years' experience with planes, especially small planes, could not identify what he saw as small planes in formation.

by Philip J. Imbrogno

Ruhl cites statements by some State Police officers that the UFO was merely a plane formation. When, however, we asked these same State Police to speak at our Brewster, New York, conference (which was attended by some 800 purported witnesses), they declined, saying, "We do not have enough evidence to prove that the sightings were caused by flying in formation."

Ruhl says the planes were flying wing-tip to wing-tip and seemed almost to hover. It is true that a plane flying into a strong wind can appear to hover, but pilots whom we asked told us that to fly five or six planes in close proximity into a strong head wind would be to invite disaster.

On the night of June 21, 1984, Ruhl photographed a plane at the Stormville Airport, allegedly the airport from which the stunt flyers flew. He assumed the plane had broken from a formation and landed separately. Ruhl accused the pilot of faking a UFO. Although the pilot hotly denied this, Ruhl took down the plane's identification numbers which, he writes, showed the craft belonged to a Mr. Hersh (or Hirsh).

On the night of June 21 a formation of planes was sighted. We talked with one of

the pilots, Peter Dine, who confirmed that he does indeed fly with friends but in a loose formation, far from wing-tip-formation flying. Also we have the names of the pilots who flew that night; a Mr. Hersh (or Hirsh) is not among them.

It is interesting to note that on this night few UFO reports were made and these came from individuals we judged to be poor witnesses. But on June 14 and July 24 there were hundreds of reported sightings. Ruhl ascribes these to planes. Yet on these two nights weather records show that the wind velocity was 30-35 mph—much too strong, we are told, for planes of the Cessna type to fly in close formation, however excellent the pilots.

Finally, two additional but unrelated points:

The *APRO Bulletin* (Vol. 29, No. 7) reports a sighting of a boomerang-shaped UFO over Lewiston, Ohio. APRO calls this a true UFO—yet the drawing accompanying the report is nearly identical to the ones made by over 20 witnesses to the Hudson Valley UFO. APRO says nothing about formation-flying in that instance.

Second, Ruhl alleges in his APRO article that the Brewster conference was intended to raise money for Dr. Hynek's Arizona research facility. This is false. At no time has Hynek accepted money from the organizers of that conference; in fact, the subject never came up.

In my opinion the Hudson Valley sightings—at least those not known to have been caused by aircraft—remain a mystery. ■

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